

ACCESS STANDARD

Passwords and Passphrases

Version 2.1

Effective date: 1 March 2026

Owner: Head of Information Security

VERSION: 2.1

DATE: 01/03/2026

REFERENCE: ACS-STD-PWD

CLASSIFICATION : INTERNAL

Purpose

This standard sets the rules for passwords and passphrases on all systems.

Staff awareness of passwords is covered in the Communication section.

Requirements

Standard user accounts

ACS-PWD-01

Applies to all user accounts without administration rights.

Minimum Length: 16 characters

Composition: three or more unrelated words
separated by a hyphen.

3

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Examples: Blue-river-lantern

Where a system cannot take a passphrase,

a password of at least 12 characters

using three kinds of character is allowed.

Local administrator accounts

ACS-PWD-02

Minimum Length: 20 characters

The password is changed every 60 days.

4

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Service accounts

ACS-PWD-03

Minimum Length: 30 characters

Communication

Staff are told never to share their passwords or passphrases.

Password and passphrase awareness is part of induction training for every password holder.